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YOGI ADITYANATH
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

Yogi Adityanath becomes UP chief minister for a record second consecutive term riding on his popularity and governance model

By Prashant Srivastava



AP

In March, Yogi Adityanath reaped the electoral dividends, arguably, of the 'Yogi Model' of governance. He became chief minister of Uttar Pradesh for a record second consecutive term, creating history. He is also the first CM in 70 years of UP's electoral past to complete a full five-year tenure. And, by the time Yogi completes his second term, he will have been the longest-serving CM of the country's most populous state.

UP's zero-tolerance approach to crime has borne fruit. The state recorded 6.08 lakh total crimes in 2021—7.5 per cent less compared to 2020 (the year of the Covid lockdown and restrictions), according to the latest National Crime Records Bureau data. Yogi says in the last five years 166 'criminals' have been killed, 4,453 injured in encounters and property worth over Rs 4,400 crore has been confiscated.

The state administration has reinvented the bulldozer, often using it to punish the state's criminals and mafias. Yogi, popularly called "Maharaj*ji*", earned a new moniker too: "Bulldozer Baba". During the UP election, he frequently referred to the heavy machine that his dispensation deployed to raze the ill-gotten property of criminals. The 'Bulldozer model' now has a following in other BJP-ruled states too like Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh and Assam. The same goes for the Uttar Pradesh Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religious Ordinance, 2020, commonly known as the 'love jihad' law, with other saffron party-ruled states such as Madhya Pradesh and Haryana preparing similar ordinances.

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The Yogi government's policies to bring in investment has also gained traction at the national level. UP has received investment proposals worth more than Rs 1.68 lakh crore through Nivesh Sarathi, a portal launched by the government before the 'Global Investors Summit-2023'.

Within the BJP, Yogi is much in demand as a star campaigner during elections, proof that he is among the most popular leaders of the country. His statements, at times controversial, his style of functioning and his handling of the law and order in the state, once dubbed 'the crime capital of India', often hit the headlines, making him a top newsmaker of the year. ■